I Lost 12 Pounds in 30 Days on 5 Peptides

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 23, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=W55M6mxQ54I Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

After 27 years of training, 43-year-old Brandon Carter calls this his easiest cut ever — 12 lbs in 30 days — crediting a 5-peptide stack that suppressed appetite, boosted energy, improved sleep, and aided injury recovery, alongside strict calorie/macro tracking and 20,000 daily steps.

📑 Contents

🧪 The 5 Peptides: What He Took and Why [0:00]

- The five peptides used over 30 days:
  - **Tirzepatide** (a GLP-1/GIP agonist) — appetite suppression
  - MC4r agonist (referred to as "Mods-C" / "Matsi") — energy
  - Epomorelin — growth hormone secretagogue
  - Tesamorelin — growth hormone secretagogue, FDA-approved for visceral fat
  - BPC-157 — injury healing
- Core analogy for why peptides are a game-changer:
  - Writing a report in the 1980s required a library card, the Dewey Decimal System, encyclopedias, a typewriter, and white-out
  - His 8-year-old son just opens an iPad
  - "Dieting on peptides is like my son using an iPad. Not using peptides feels like when I had to deal with the library and the Dewey Decimal System."
- His concern: once this becomes mainstream, it won't feel special — but he believes most people will still mess it up by not tracking

🍽️ Nutrition Protocol: Calories, Macros, and the Protein Problem [1:59]

- **Tirzepatide's core effect:** drastically reduces appetite — which creates a hidden danger for muscle retention
    - With appetite suppressed, you will NOT accidentally eat enough protein
    - He weighed ~200 lbs and forced himself to hit **200 g of protein per day** (1 g per lb of body weight)
    - It was a genuine struggle — required drinking multiple protein shakes because liquids are easier to get down than solid food
    - Eating a normal breakfast felt like eating a full Thanksgiving dinner
- Why people get "frail" on GLPs:
    - They inject and don't track — they under-eat everything, including protein, and lose muscle along with fat
    - Tracking is the differentiator between looking "jacked" vs. just "skinny"
- His exact numbers over the final 7-day average:

Metric	Value
Average daily calories consumed	1,737
Average daily calories burned (Oura Ring)	~2,861
Average daily caloric deficit	1,124

- Macro philosophy:
    - Protein and total calories are the two non-negotiables
    - Fat vs. carb split doesn't matter much — do whatever suits you
    - He personally does **lower carb / higher fat** and has been keto for 11 years
    - "I don't really care what the fats and carbohydrates are. As long as your calories and proteins are on point."

📊 Tracking Tools: AI, Wearables, and the Free RIP Roadmap [3:29]

- He tracks all food and calories using **Claude AI** (not ChatGPT — because Claude syncs with Apple Health)
    - Just has a conversation with Claude; logs meals by talking to it
    - Claude checks Apple Health data to show both calories consumed AND calories burned
    - Provides a running calorie deficit tally every time he logs
    - Free prompts he uses are linked in the video description
- Wearable for calorie burn: **Oura Ring**
    - Syncs calorie burn data to Apple Health → Apple Health syncs to Claude
    - ChatGPT does not currently sync with Apple Health
- Caveat: wearable calorie data isn't 100% accurate, but provides a solid barometer
- **Free tool: RIP Roadmap** (link in description)

- Enter height, weight, gender, goal, and upload a photo
- AI estimates body fat percentage and pounds of fat to lose
- Gives exact calorie and macro targets for the goal
- Allows adjusting fat/carb split
- Provides a week-by-week roadmap projection
- 100% free

⚡ MC4r Agonist (Mots-C): Energy and Caffeine Reduction [6:33]

- Problem it solves: deep caloric deficits cause lethargy and low energy ("mild starvation")
- The MC4r agonist gave him noticeably elevated energy throughout the cut
- **Unexpected side effect:** he stopped feeling compelled to take as much caffeine
  - He had been averaging ~1 gram of caffeine per day for 20+ years
  - Now taking roughly half that, and not deliberately — just not craving it
  - Still takes caffeine recreationally (pre-workout or before sex) but doesn't rely on it
- His take on caloric deficit and energy:
  - Any deficit is mild starvation — your body uses stored fat as fuel
  - Feeling weak in a deficit is normal, but the MC4r agonist counteracted this
- The MC4r agonist and tirzepatide work synergistically: one kills appetite, the other restores energy → "easiest cut of my life in a pretty substantial deficit"

😴 Epomorelin & Tesamorelin: Sleep and Growth Hormone [9:14]

- Both are **growth hormone secretagogues** — they signal the pituitary gland to produce more pulses of growth hormone
- Growth hormone is both anabolic (muscle-preserving) and lipolytic (fat-burning)
- **Tesamorelin** is FDA-approved specifically for reducing visceral fat (belly/gut fat)
- Key benefit: **significantly improved sleep**
  - Growth hormone spikes improve sleep quality
  - Deep deficits normally cause cortisol spikes at 2–3 AM that wake you up — this did not happen
  - He describes this as the best sleep of his adult life
  - Caveat: improved sleep may partially be due to less caffeine intake (credit possibly to MC4r agonist)
  - Still, substantial data supports sleep benefits from GH secretagogues
- Did they directly cause fat loss? Hard to isolate — his deficit was large enough that fat loss was inevitable regardless
  - Main value: made the cut *easier* by preserving sleep quality

🩹 BPC-157: Injury Recovery [11:09]

- Not taken for fat loss or body composition — purely for **chronic injury healing**
- Injuries being treated:
  - Chronic trap ache from years of daily handstand push-up variations (likely a decade or more of irritation)
  - Bicep injury from performing the "human flag" exercise at over 200 lbs — damage that had never fully healed in 10+ years
- Results after one month:
  - Trap ache: "I can feel it if I look for it, but I gotta look for it"
  - Bicep: has to manipulate arm/wrist in specific ways to find the pain — previously a constant, chronic presence
  - "That's amazing because this is something I've been dealing with for over 10 years"
- No direct body composition contribution noted

🏋️ Training Protocol: Full-Body Workouts and Steps [12:16]

- Workout structure:
  - Full-body workouts, **4–5 days per week**
  - 1–2 exercises per body part
  - Focus on **compound movements**
  - 3–4 sets per exercise
  - **Maximum 90 seconds rest** between sets — timed with Apple Watch Ultra
  - Workouts never exceeded one hour
- Why full-body workouts don't take 3 hours: he puts his phone away, starts the timer immediately after each set, and gets back to work
- Trained in his building's home gym (empty because neighbors use a different gym that opened nearby)
- Cardio: **20,000 steps per day**
  - Didn't hit it every single day — life gets in the way
  - Achieved it on **more than 80% of days**
  - Average daily calorie burn came out to nearly **3,000 calories/day** across the month
- Mindset on missed days:
  - Don't throw your hands up if you miss one day — look at your average
  - Analogy: a salesperson doesn't expect to close every deal; performance is judged weekly, monthly, quarterly
  - One bad week → address it; two bad weeks → have a conversation; a bad quarter → fired

📉 Breaking Down the 12 Pounds Lost [14:58]

- Total weight lost: **12 lbs in 30 days**
- Math breakdown:

Component	Calculation	Result
Avg daily deficit	tracked	1,124 cal/day
Calories per lb of fat	standard	3,500 cal
Pure fat lost (math)	1,124 × 30 ÷ 3,500	~9.6 lbs
Remaining ~2–3 lbs	water weight, glycogen, glucose	not muscle

- Evidence that muscle was retained: **none of his lifting weights dropped**
- Why you look smaller even without losing muscle:
  - Depleted glycogen = less fullness and volume in the muscles
  - A couple high-calorie or high-carb days would "plump up" the muscles again via glycogen refilling
  - High protein (300–400 g) can also cause gluconeogenesis, converting extra protein to glucose and filling out the muscles
- Key retention principle: **1 g protein per lb of bodyweight + heavy lifting = retain the majority of muscle**
- He plans to extend the peptide protocol: "I think I'mma extend this. I'm going to keep taking something because this makes everything easier."
- Only remaining challenge: forcing enough protein intake — solution is more protein shakes